# Moving Freely Around the Keyboard

Scales, arpeggios and planned movement in familiar major and minor keys.

## How to use these notes

Read alongside the lessons or keep beside your piano. Review the explanations, try the practice tasks, then use the checklist without on-screen hints. Listening and demonstrations are available in the app. Notation examples show the opening two bars; full songs are in the Songbook.

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## 1. Two-octave major scales

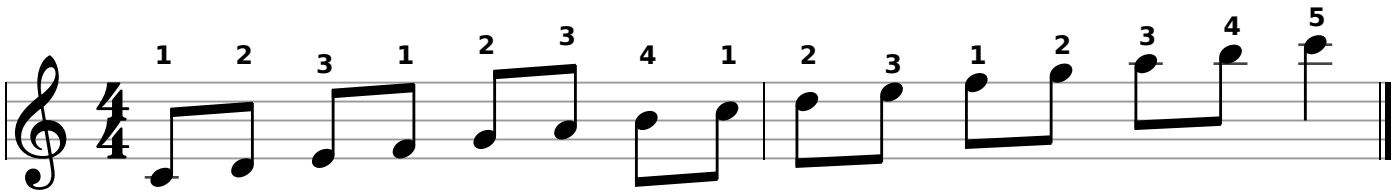
Join the middle octave with an organised fingering.

### Two-octave major scales

Practise C, G and F major first, then D and B-flat. In a two-octave right-hand C scale, use 1 2 3, 1 2 3 4, then cross to 1 for the next octave; save 5 for the very top. The middle C is not an ending. Move the forearm along the keyboard and keep the thumb crossing small.

#### Practise · C major, two octaves

Hands separately first. Use 1 at the middle C and 5 only at the top.




Opening example · 4/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

#### Practise · B-flat preparation

Right hand: begin with 2 on B-flat. Avoid twisting to tuck the thumb.

#### Practise · G major, two octaves

Hands separately. Keep the middle octave moving and reverse calmly at the top.

### Practise · F major, two octaves

Hands separately. Keep the middle octave moving and reverse calmly at the top.

### Practise · D major, two octaves

Hands separately. Keep the middle octave moving and reverse calmly at the top.

### Practise · Bb major, two octaves

Hands separately. Keep the middle octave moving and reverse calmly at the top.

### Practise · C major, left hand

Use 1 at the middle C, cross 4 to D above it, and reverse the same route.

### Listen and check

Play the ascent and descent offline with the same relaxed crossings. Practise G with C fingering, F with 4 on B-flat, and D with 3 on F-sharp; do not raise speed until the joins are even.

The app checks pitches. Use Flow for note-start timing; judge held notes, physical ease, balance and pedal by listening. Repeat a short passage before increasing speed.

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## 2. Natural and harmonic minor

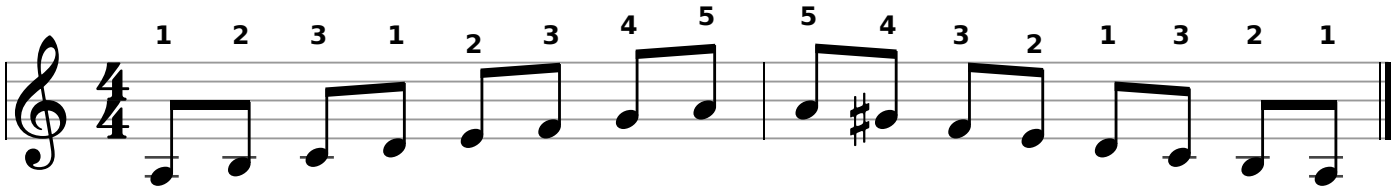
Hear the raised seventh lead toward the home note.

### Natural and harmonic minor

A natural minor shares the white keys with C major. Harmonic minor raises the seventh: G becomes G-sharp in A minor. Compare the two sounds before memorising a pattern. Prepare A, D and E minor separately; D harmonic minor raises C to C-sharp and E harmonic minor raises D to D-sharp.

### Practise · A minor: two colours

Play natural minor, then notice the raised G-sharp.




Opening example · 4/4 · Am · finger 1 = thumb

### Practise · D and E leading notes

Hear each raised seventh resolve upward. Use small hand movements.

### Practise · Am harmonic minor

Use the raised seventh in both directions. Keep the wider step relaxed.

### Practise · Dm harmonic minor

Use the raised seventh in both directions. Keep the wider step relaxed.

### Practise · Em harmonic minor

Use the raised seventh in both directions. Keep the wider step relaxed.

### Listen and check

Sing the final two notes before playing them. Can you explain which note changed and why its pull toward home sounds stronger?

The app checks pitches. Use Flow for note-start timing; judge held notes, physical ease, balance and pedal by listening. Repeat a short passage before increasing speed.

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## 3. Plan the fingering before the leap

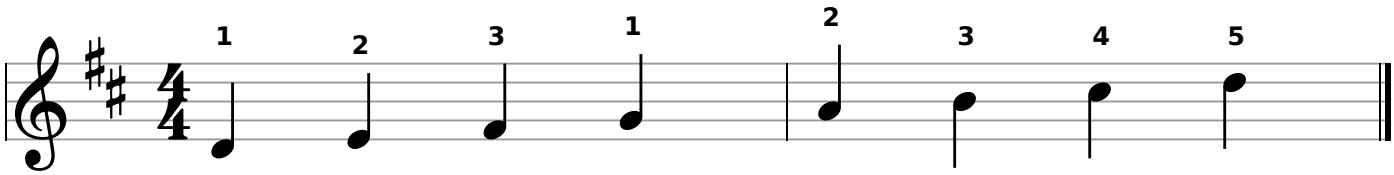
Use consistent fingers and release between positions.

### Plan the fingering before the leap

A useful fingering supports the musical shape and fits your hand. Mark the beginning of each group, the highest note, and each crossing. Try a choice slowly twice before keeping it. Changing fingers every attempt makes the movement harder to remember. Releasing between groups is safer than forcing a large stretch.

### Practise · An organised crossing

Use the written crossing and let the arm follow the hand.




Opening example · 4/4 · D · finger 1 = thumb

### Practise · Prepare a new position

Release during the rest and look at the landing note.

### Listen and check

Could you repeat the same fingering three times without a last-second scramble? If not, slow down and plan the move before adding the preceding bar.

The app checks pitches. Use Flow for note-start timing; judge held notes, physical ease, balance and pedal by listening. Repeat a short passage before increasing speed.

## 4. Arpeggios without a stretched hand

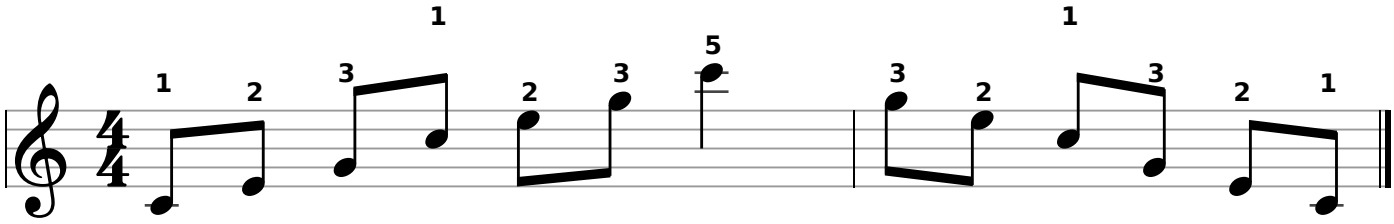
Travel through chord tones one note at a time.

### Arpeggios without a stretched hand

An arpeggio spreads a chord across time. First identify the notes, then choose a fingering that lets the arm travel. In the right-hand C pattern below, 1 2 3 leads to 1 on the next C. Practise one octave before joining two. Keep the wrist flexible; the fingers do not need to stay spread after their notes end.

### Practise · Right-hand C arpeggio

Travel C-E-G-C. Cross gently, then reverse the movement.




Opening example · 4/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

### Practise · Left-hand chord tones

Start with a comfortable octave. Move rather than stretch.

### Listen and check

Listen for bumps at the thumb crossings. Repeat the crossing pair alone, then place it back into the full arpeggio.

The app checks pitches. Use Flow for note-start timing; judge held notes, physical ease, balance and pedal by listening. Repeat a short passage before increasing speed.

## 5. Read the pattern, not every isolated note
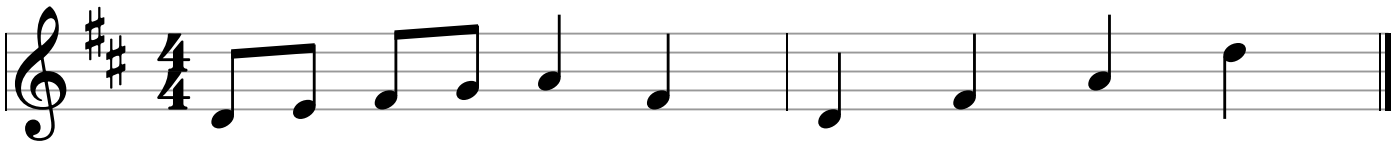
Recognise scales, chords and repeated sequences.

### Read the pattern, not every isolated note

Before playing a passage, circle the notes that belong to a scale and bracket the notes that outline a chord. An accidental is a useful warning that the pattern changes. Pattern recognition reduces the amount you have to decode, but always check the starting pitch and the direction.

### Practise · Scale then chord

Name the first group as a scale and the second as a broken chord.



Opening example · 4/4 · D · finger 1 = thumb

### Practise · The same shape, another key

Notice the same contour beginning on F.

### Listen and check

Look away from the keyboard and describe the shape: up by step, skip, or chord. Can you identify the same pattern in the hymn study?

The app checks pitches. Use Flow for note-start timing; judge held notes, physical ease, balance and pedal by listening. Repeat a short passage before increasing speed.

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## 6. Holy, Holy, Holy: D-major movement

Find the D-major shapes before playing. Keep the running left hand soft and the repeated melody notes calm.
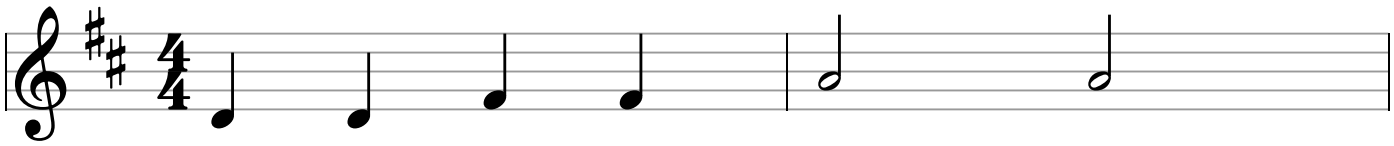
### What to listen for

Find the D-major shapes before playing. Keep the running left hand soft and the repeated melody notes calm.

Prepare the opening with separate hands. Then use Play along, choose the hand you want to practise, and loop the troublesome bars. Count the pickup as bar 1 in the loop selector.

### Practise · Melody alone

Find the D-major shapes before playing. Keep the running left hand soft and the repeated melody notes calm.



Opening example · 4/4 · D · finger 1 = thumb

### Practise · Accompaniment alone

Play the left hand softly. Count through the held notes and rests.

### Practise · Opening together

Find the D-major shapes before playing. Keep the running left hand soft and the repeated melody notes calm.

### Practise · Holy, Holy, Holy: D-major movement

Find the D-major shapes before playing. Keep the running left hand soft and the repeated melody notes calm.

**Your musical check**

Loop one position change, then join it to the preceding bar.

Play again without the demonstration. Explain what you changed and whether it sounded better.

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## 7. What a Friend: F-major patterns

Prepare B-flat and identify scale fragments before adding the broken-chord accompaniment.
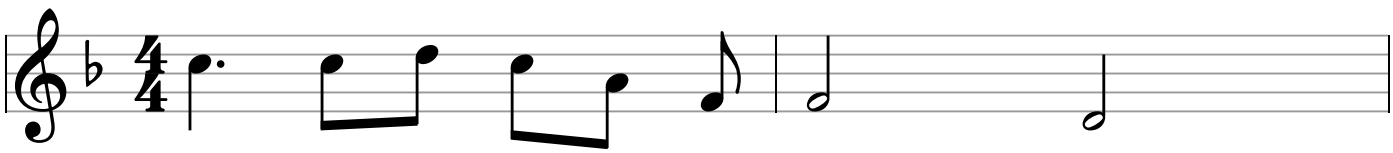
**What to listen for**

Prepare B-flat and identify scale fragments before adding the broken-chord accompaniment.

Prepare the opening with separate hands. Then use Play along, choose the hand you want to practise, and loop the troublesome bars. Count the pickup as bar 1 in the loop selector.

### Practise · Melody alone

Prepare B-flat and identify scale fragments before adding the broken-chord accompaniment.



Opening example · 4/4 · F · finger 1 = thumb

### Practise · Accompaniment alone

Play the left hand softly. Count through the held notes and rests.

### Practise · Opening together

Prepare B-flat and identify scale fragments before adding the broken-chord accompaniment.

### Practise · What a Friend: F-major patterns

Prepare B-flat and identify scale fragments before adding the broken-chord accompaniment.

**Your musical check**

Did your arm travel with the hand without stretching for the next group?

Play again without the demonstration. Explain what you changed and whether it sounded better.

## 8. Joyful, Joyful in G

Keep scale-like melody patterns even above a soft arpeggiated accompaniment.

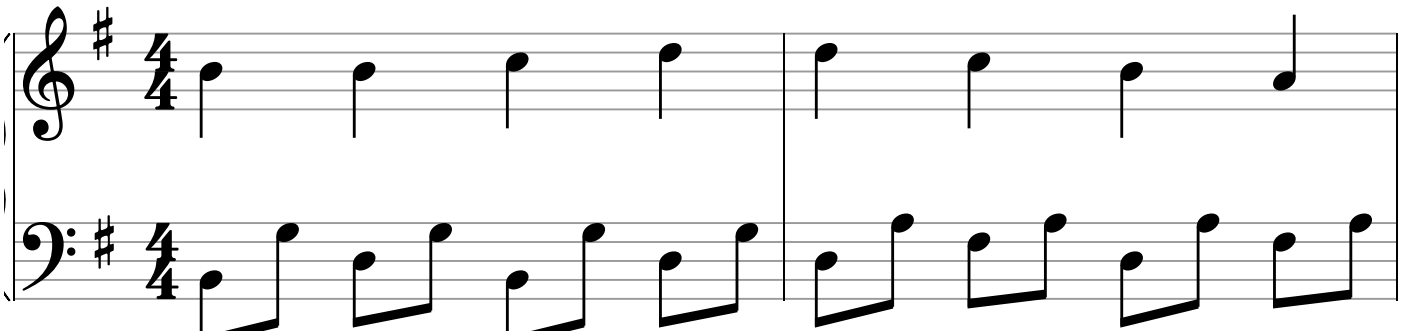
### Prepare your recital

Keep scale-like melody patterns even above a soft arpeggiated accompaniment.

Choose a comfortable tempo. Practise difficult bars separately, then reconnect them. Make one uninterrupted run before marking your recital complete. Completion records a play-through, not a certified grade.

### Practise · Dress rehearsal: Joyful, Joyful in G

Keep scale-like melody patterns even above a soft arpeggiated accompaniment.



Opening example · 4/4 · G · finger 1 = thumb

### Practise · Your recital

Take a breath, prepare the starting notes, and play through. Keep going after a small mistake. Keep scale-like melody patterns even above a soft arpeggiated accompaniment.

## Can I do this independently?

Try these at your piano with hints and note labels turned off. Tick a box when you can do it comfortably; return to the matching lesson when you need a reminder.

- ☐ Join the middle octave with an organised fingering.
- ☐ Hear the raised seventh lead toward the home note.
- ☐ Use consistent fingers and release between positions.
- ☐ Travel through chord tones one note at a time.
- ☐ Recognise scales, chords and repeated sequences.
- ☐ Keep scale-like melody patterns even above a soft arpeggiated accompaniment.

**My next practice goal**

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**What sounded better? What still needs work?**

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